

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

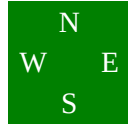
♠ 8 6
 ♥ A K 7 2
 ♦ 9 5 3
 ♣ Q 10 3 2

♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ 9 4

♦ A K Q J

♣ A K



♠ K J 3
 ♥ J 10 8 5
 ♦ 10 6
 ♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ A 10 5

♥ Q 6 3

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ J 8 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

back toward his ♠ Q, playing West for the ♠ K. If he plays this way you will get two tricks and defeat the contract.

[showcards S:S4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♥ J, covered by dummy's ♥ Q and won by West's ♥ K. West wins the ♥ A at the second trick and continues with a small ♥ ruffed by North.

North then plays the ♠ 4 from his hand. Do you play low? or play the ♠ J to force dummy's ♠ A?

Play the ♠ 3.

If North decides to finesse the ♠ 10 then you will still win the one ♠ trick which you are entitled to win.

However, with North holding the ♠ Q it would be very logical for him to go up with the ♠ A then lead

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7 4
 ♥ A J 10
 ♦ Q J 4
 ♣ Q J 10 7

♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 5 4 3



♠ A 10 8
 ♥ K Q 4
 ♦ A K 10
 ♣ A 9 8 2

♠ 9 5 3

♥ 9 8 7 2

♦ 8 6 5 3

♣ K 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		2NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			
6NT by East			

[showcards N:S4]

You are North. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. East's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, West has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore South must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that South **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since South will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

East has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠10 and made the slam.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ 9 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

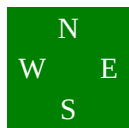
♣ K Q 4

♠ K J 5

♥ Q 7 4

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A J 9 5



♠ 7 6 3

♥ K J 10

♦ K J 9 6

♣ 10 7 2

♠ A Q 4

♥ A 8 5

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ 8 6 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

If you play low, he **MIGHT** finesse the ♣J and again establish 3 ♣ winners. But South's correct play would be to put on dummy's ♣9, finessing West for the ♣10. This is because ♣ K 10 **or** ♣ Q 10 are twice as likely as ♣ K Q.

If he does play this way East will win the ♣10 and your ♣ K Q will get one more trick.

[showcards S:C3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠10; low cards from North and East, won by South with the ♠A.

South next plays the ♣3 and you must decide whether to split your ♣ K Q.

Play the ♣4.

If you split your Honors, playing the ♣Q perhaps, dummy's ♣A will take the trick and South will later play through your ♣K toward dummy's ♣ J 9 5. Played in this way he will establish 3 ♣ winners (which he needs for the contract).